

- It has no menus.
 - Your terminal shows a part of the file on which you are working.
 - It allows all kinds of text editing.
- Vim (VI Improved) is the enhanced version of the Visual editor.

Highlights of Vim

- It is usually available on all varieties of the Unix system.
- Its applications are similar across all the platforms.
- It requires very few resources.
- It has a user-friendly interface, certainly better than other text editors like the Elvis, Nvi, or Nano.

You can create a new file from scratch or edit an existing file using the VI text editor. You can also use this editor in the read-only mode to view a document.

What are the modes on VI?

VI works in two different modes: command mode and insert mode.

● Command mode

Command mode is the default mode that VI is in on starting. As the name suggests, command mode allows you to give editing commands and modify text. If you type any character in the command mode, it will not be displayed on the window and will instead be interpreted as a command. Some commands will appear on the last line.

Commands help you to navigate around in the file, exit the file, copy, paste, delete, or make any other kind of change that you want. They are also case-sensitive. 'K' will not be the same as 'k'.

If you are in the insert mode, you can switch to the command mode by pressing the Escape key.

Note: While the VI editor is in the command mode, you can invoke an escape mode or the 'last line' mode by typing a colon. This moves the cursor to the last line of the screen. This mode allows you to perform tasks such as saving files or executing commands.

● Insert mode

You can use this mode for inserting text into your file. All the characters that you type are taken as normal input and are displayed on your editor window.